Hedge Cutter



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Hedge cutter

What it is used for

A hedge cutter trims hedges, shrubs, and suitable garden growth using reciprocating or rotating cutting blades. Use the correct tool for the plant material and maintain safe distance from people, cables, and hidden objects.

Main parts

- Cutting blade or blade bar
- Front and rear handles
- Trigger, switch, and safety lock
- Electric cord, battery, or engine power unit
- Blade guard or protective cover
- Hand guard and safety controls

Before you start

1. Inspect the blade, guard, handles, switches, and power source for damage.
2. For electric models, check the cord and plug; for battery models, check the battery condition.
3. For engine models, check fuel and engine condition according to instructions.
4. Clear the hedge of visible wire, stones, and other foreign objects.
5. Check the work area for people, pets, traffic, and overhead or hidden cables.
6. Wear eye protection, hearing protection, sturdy footwear, and suitable gloves.

How to use

1. Keep the tool switched off while inspecting or adjusting the blade.
2. Fit the blade guard correctly for transport and remove it only before operation.
3. Hold the tool with both hands using the designated handles.
4. Stand securely with balanced footing and keep the blade away from the body.
5. Start the tool according to the manufacturer's procedure.
6. Begin cutting at a manageable section and use smooth, controlled strokes.
7. Keep the cutting blade clear of soil, walls, fences, and other hard objects.
8. Do not force the blade through branches thicker than the tool's rated capacity.
9. Release the trigger and wait for the blades to stop before repositioning or clearing debris.
10. Switch off and isolate the power source before removing tangled material or making adjustments.
11. After cutting, switch off the tool and wait until all moving parts stop.
12. Clean the blade, inspect for damage, and apply approved blade care product if specified.

3. Fit the blade guard and store the tool securely.

⚠ Safety

- Only trained users should operate powered hedge cutters.
- Keep both hands on the designated handles and never reach toward moving blades.
- Keep people and pets well outside the cutting area.
- Do not use in rain or wet conditions unless the tool is specifically rated for them.
- Never cut near power lines or hidden cables; maintain required clearance and seek qualified help when needed.
- Disconnect the plug, remove the battery, or isolate the engine before maintenance.

Care & storage

- Clean plant residue from the blade after each use.
- Inspect blade teeth, fasteners, guards, and handles regularly.
- Lubricate and sharpen blades only according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Store with the blade guard fitted in a dry, secure place.
- Report unusual vibration, damaged blades, or faulty switches before reuse.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Cutting without checking for hidden wire or other obstacles.
- Using one hand or standing in an unstable position.
- Clearing tangled branches while the blades are moving.
- Using the cutter on branches beyond its rated cutting capacity.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar